



The Competency Matrix

- Helping develop our people in line with the business need

PAB-IT 31st August 2011

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The Competency Matrix - Helping develop our people in line with the business need PAB-IT 31st August 2011



Objectives

- Why do we need the competency matrix - Business need
- What is the scope?
- What do we mean by competency?
- What does the matrix contain?
- How is the matrix going to be used? (including benefits)
- The matrix
- How does the matrix relate to other things such as JDs, PDRs, objective setting, etc.?
- Where are we and what are the next steps?

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Objectives



Why do we need a competency matrix?

- » What are the current competencies of our engineers? (*e.g. how many engineers do we have that are capable of undertaking a particular role?*)
- » Does this match business needs? (*e.g. do we need more people with particular competencies?*)
- » What competencies might we need in the future? (*e.g. what competencies might our staff need to develop if we are to undertake more external business?*)
- » How do we help give our engineers the best advice on how they might want to develop themselves? (*e.g. what should they concentrate on and why*)
- » How do we help our staff develop their competencies?

Competency matrix addresses all of the above

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Why do we need a competency matrix?



What do we mean by “competency”?

Overall

Capability = Competency
+ Domain Knowledge
+ Specific Skills

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What do we mean by “competency”?



Example

A software engineer is needed on NERC

Desired = (Ability to translate a low level design into code)
Capability + Domain knowledge of > 1 NERC subsystems
+ C

Applicant 1 = (Ability to translate a low level design into code)
+ Domain knowledge of 1 NERC subsystems
+ Ada

Applicant 2 = (Ability to translate a low level design into code)
+ No Domain knowledge of NERC
+ C

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Example



What does the Competency Matrix contain?

- » Matches generic roles to competency groupings.
- » Competency groupings based on external industry recognised models:
 - » Software – BCS SFIAPlus
 - » Testing – ISEB/ISTQB (International Software Testing Qualifications Board)
 - » Systems – INCOSE (International Council on Systems Engineering)
 - » WPM – above plus APM (Association for Project Management)
 - » Running the process and Mgt Data - E-Competence
- » Plus NATS Leadership Model
- » The matrix covers both technical and behavioural competencies.
- » Each individual competency has four levels (1 to 4 with 4 the highest) which are fully described in the matrix
- » For each generic role there is a corresponding set of scores (levels) for all of the associated competencies (= a profile).

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What does the Competency Matrix contain?



How is the matrix going to be used? - Benefits

» Business

- » Clearer view of staff competencies. This helps in deciding what kind of work we can undertake and whether we have a shortage in any particular area, both now and in the future.
- » More objective feedback so staff will be clearer on areas they need to develop
- » This will help managers give guidance to staff on development for the future and hence be better able to meet future business need.

» Individual

- » More objective way of helping to understand development needs
- » Clearer guidance on how to develop and to what degree
- » Along with the generic JDs gives clearer guidance on what a new role looks like. This can be used to help prepare staff for future roles and to produce the development plan once in the new role.
- » Clearer guidance on how to develop themselves for the future in line with NATS changing needs.
- » Greater consistency across AE in how development needs are identified and progressed.

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How is the matrix going to be used? - Benefits



How is the matrix going to be used?

- Current Role

- » Need a baseline from which to help staff develop – individual profile.
- » A comparison can then be made of the individual with their current role (individual profile vs role profile)
- » Discuss any areas to be developed.
- » Discuss “raising the bar”.
- » Actions captured in PDR

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How is the matrix going to be used? - Current Role



How is the matrix going to be used?

- New role

- » Compare Individual's profile to that of the new role.
- » Future role - agree development actions and how they will be achieved.
- » Imminent role – agree development actions and include in development plan for new role.
- » Actions captured in PDR.

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How is the matrix going to be used? - New role



How is the matrix going to be used?

- Future Competencies

- » Working group to discuss competency changes.
- » Compare individual's profile with the new competencies profile
- » Discuss and agree development actions and how they will be achieved.
- » Actions captured in PDR.

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How is the matrix going to be used? - Future Competencies

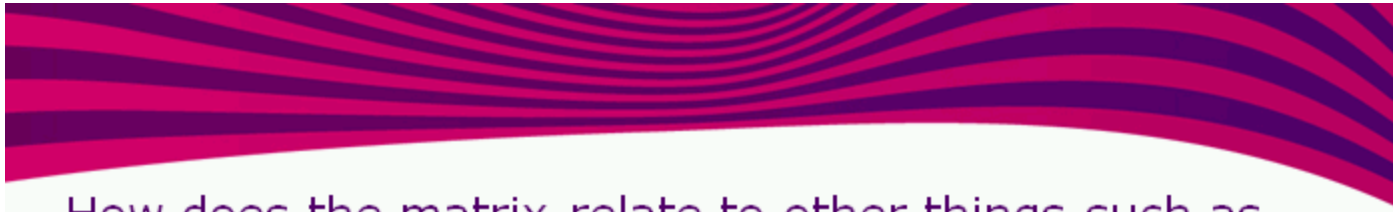


How do we produce an individual's competency profile?

- » For each competency read out the associated description at each of the four levels. You can usually put aside 2 immediately (either too low or too high). You then discuss in greater detail the two remaining levels.
- » The individual should give specific examples of where he/she feels they have met the description. The manager should use feedback obtained (via PDRs, MTRs, ad-hoc) to give his/her views. In some cases it may be necessary to gather additional feedback before reaching any agreement.
- » An individual must fully meet the level to claim competency at that level. If only partly meets then the lower level is used.
- » Output will be the individual's profile (agreed level for each competency).

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How do we produce an individual's competency profile?



How does the matrix relate to other things such as JDs, PDRs, objective setting, etc.?

- » Working with Jos Brown to align the role descriptions in the matrix with the generic JDs being developed.
- » The discussions relating to an individual's competency profile will form part of the input to PDRs, 1-2-1's, etc.
- » Actions will be captured in PDR.

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How does the matrix relate to other things such as JDs, PDRs, objective setting, etc.?



Where are we and what are the next steps?

- » ADA, SDA and Architect roles recently added, SEM & Safety soon.
- » Presented to Unions, meeting again next week.
- » Working on guide lines document – ready for review by end of March.
- » Review matrix within CAE by end of April. Will get a number of people (including union reps) to use the matrix to look at their own competency profile. Will also get managers to compare profiles at a number of grades.
- » Define and agree how benefits will be measured by mid May
- » Produce briefing material by end of May. This is for managers and staff.
- » Hold briefing sessions during June.
- » We would like the process to be rolled out by end of July.
- » Work with other AE areas (particularly Infrastructure) to add/update matrix for their areas and issue next version of the matrix by end of September (also taking on board general feedback from other areas)
- » Produce guidance on developing competencies by end of September.

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Where are we and what are the next steps?



Remaining considerations

» Profiles

- » How and where they will be stored
- » How they are accessed
- » Individual must only be able to see their own profile
- » Line managers need to be able to see all their staff (as they currently can with PDR)
- » Management reports required to answer questions such as “what does the competency profile look like across our staff?”, “what competencies do we need to develop?”
- » This need not delay any roll out. Initially the profile can be held privately by the individual and line manager. This will allow the individual to start befitting immediately but will not easily allow the management reports to be produced.

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Remaining considerations



Objectives Reminder

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Objectives Reminder



The End